

Repeats

Repetition is one of the important unifying aspects of music.

Most musical forms employ some degree of repetition, whether on a small scale—a few measures—or repeating entire sections.

Simple repeat symbol

The repeat symbol, a double bar preceded by two dots, means to return to wherever you see the inverted, or reversed, repeat symbol and repeat the material in between. If there is no reversed repeat sign, go back to the beginning and repeat.



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△ **Two repeat symbols**

The final repeat sign indicates to go back to the reversed repeat sign, shown here in the second measure, and replay that section.

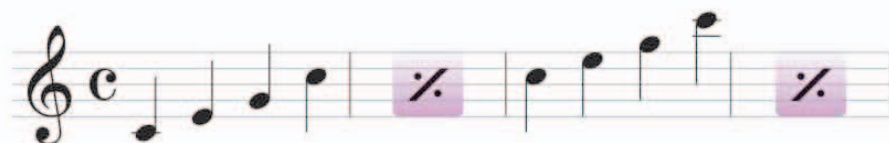


△ One repeat symbol

The absence of a reversed repeat sign indicates a return to the beginning, to replay the entire section.

Repeat one or two measures

A one-measure repeat is notated by a single slash with two dots, within the measure immediately after the measure to be repeated. There is no limit to the number of one-measure repeats that composers may use, although for ease in performance the number of measures to be repeated is usually placed over the measure, if greater than one.



◁ Repeating a measure

If only one measure of music is to be repeated, you will see this symbol indicating to repeat the previous measure one time.



◁ Repeating two measures

If two measures are to be repeated, the symbol used has two slashes and the number 2 above it. This means to repeat the previous two measures one time.